

QUICKSTART: HOW TO PLAY *KAR-TA-NA*

This section explains the basics of the game in 3–5 minutes.

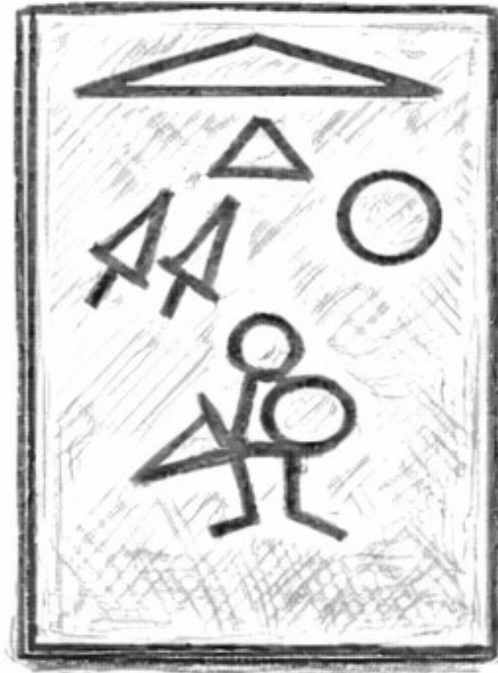
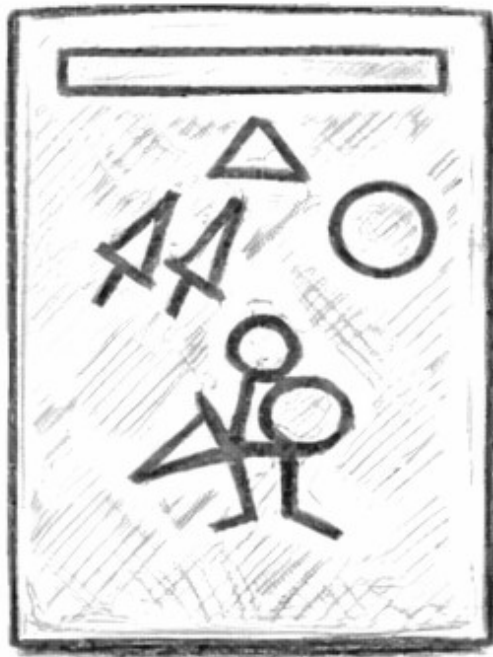
It is meant for first-time players and does **not** replace the full rulebook.

1. What the Game Is About

Kar-Ta-Na is a tactical game where you deploy pieces from your marching column, move them across the board, orient them, and then use weapons and special actions to destroy enemy pieces.

Each piece has:

- a **state** (marching / combat),
- an **orientation** (which way it faces),
- **movement, defense, weapon,**
- **special rules.**



2. How to Win

By default, you win if you destroy **all enemy pieces**, including those still in the opponent's marching column.

If a player has no pieces on the board **and cannot deploy a new one**, they immediately lose.

3. Setup

1. Each player forms their **marching column** — a stack of pieces with the marching side up.
The top piece is revealed.
 2. Determine the **deployment line** — the edge nodes where pieces may enter the board.
 3. Determine the first player.
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4. Turn Structure

Each turn has two phases:

1. **Movement Phase** — only pieces in marching state activate.
2. **Action Phase** — only pieces in combat state activate.

In both phases, players alternate activations:

A → B → A → B → ...

5. Movement Phase (Basics)

On your activation, choose **one** piece in marching state.

Option 1: A piece already on the board

The piece:

- may move up to **D** nodes orthogonally,
- may change direction freely,
- may not pass through occupied nodes,
- may perform a **turn in place**.

At the end of its activation:

- the piece gains an orientation,
- then flips to **combat state**.

Option 2: A piece from the marching column

If a deployment node is free:

- the piece enters in **marching state**,
- may move,
- then gains an orientation,
- then flips to **combat state**.

Forced Deployment

If a player has **no pieces on the board**, they must deploy a piece from their column.

6. Action Phase (Basics)

Pieces in **combat state** activate.

A piece performs **one action**:

- attack with a chosen weapon,
- use a special rule,
- or simply flip (if it has no actions or the player chooses not to act).

After activation, the piece flips to **marching state**.

A piece **cannot change orientation** in this phase (unless its rules explicitly allow it).

7. How Attacks Work

An attack is possible if:

- the target is on the same rank or file,
- the distance fits the weapon's range,
- no other pieces block the line (unless the weapon ignores blocking).

Bag Test

1. Attacker adds beads = weapon's Attack value.
 2. Defender adds beads = Defense value + distance bonuses.
 3. Orientation bonuses:
 - flank attack: +1 to attacker
 - rear attack: +2 to attacker
 - attacker's flank exposed: +1 to defender
 - attacker's rear exposed: +2 to defender
 4. Draw one bead:
 - attacker's color → target destroyed
 - defender's color → attack fails
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8. Life Stacks

If a piece is a stack:

- its parameters are determined by the **top tile**,
 - when damaged, the top tile is removed,
 - if the stack is empty, the unit is destroyed.
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9. When a Phase Ends

A phase ends when:

- both players pass,
- or all pieces have been flipped into the appropriate state.

10. Start Playing Right Now

1. Set up the board.
2. Prepare the columns.
3. Mark the deployment line.
4. The first player begins the **Movement Phase**.
5. Players alternate activations.
6. When all pieces are in combat state, switch to the **Action Phase**.
7. Repeat until one player wins.

11. Example Pieces

Name	Move (D)	Defense	Weapon	Special Rules	Material / Color
Basic Warrior	1	1	Melee 1 / 1-1	—	Any, usually common
Skirmisher	1	1	Melee 1 / 1-1; Ranged 1 / 2-2	—	Any
Archer	1	1	Melee 1 / 1-1; Ranged 2 / 2-4	—	Any
Shieldbearer	1	2	Melee 1 / 1-1	—	Any
Veteran	1	2	Melee 2 / 1-1	—	Medium-value material
Light Cavalry	5	1	Melee 1 / 1-1; Ranged 1 / 2-2	—	Medium-value material

Name	Move (D)	Defense	Weapon	Special Rules	Material / Color
Medium Cavalry	5	2	Melee 2 / 1–1	—	Medium-value material
War Elephant	2	3	Melee 3 / 1–1; (if full stack) Ranged 1 / 2–2	Stack of 3 tiles; at 1 tile left, 50/50 control check each activation	Very rare material
Special Piece: Maneuver Order	—	—	—	Not placed on the board; when activated, flips any number of your pieces; then discarded	Rare material
Special Piece: Flanking Entry	0	2	—	Enters any free edge node and never moves again; while in marching state, counts as a deployment point	Special material